Indian Ocean Blue Tourism Cluster Branding & Communication Perspective

- Aligning stakeholders, positioning, and market clarity - From individual destinations → a coherent regional offer

Stakeholder Mapping Who We Need to Engage (and Why)

Institutional: - Tourism boards - Blue economy / environment ministries - Investment agencies Private Sector: - Tour operators & DMCs - Hotel groups - Marine activity providers Development & Regional: - AFD, EU, World Bank - NGOs - Cap Business OI Communication Multipliers: - DMOs - Certification bodies - Tour operators Key point: Stakeholders shape and transmit the brand

Institutional Landscape Strong Foundations, Limited Alignment

- Blue Economy strategies - Sustainable tourism policies - Climate commitments Challenge: Not yet unified into one narrative Branding role: Translate policy into a clear value proposition

Engagement Dynamics What Will Influence Stakeholder Ownership

- Public vs private alignment - Uneven development - Competition vs collaboration - Credibility risks
Implication: Position Blue Tourism as a shared opportunity

Success Stories Global Benchmarks

Alpine Pearls → aligned multi-destination theme Danube Cycle Path → clear, bookable cross-border product Palau → strong sustainability narrative (Palau Pledge) Norway → certification + storytelling Caribbean Tourism Organization → regional identity

Past Experience Positioning My Contribution

- No prior collaboration with CBOI Strengths: - Independent regional perspective - Destination branding experience - Market positioning expertise

Closing Key Takeaway

- Strong assets and policies exist - Gap: clarity and positioning Branding turns six destinations into one compelling system